

Word family: **caption / captions / captioned / captioning**

Base word: caption

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

caption (n.) — 圖片說明；標題文字；字幕

caption (v.) — 為圖片加說明；加字幕

captioned (adj./participle) — 附有說明文字的；加字幕的

captioning (n.) — 加字幕；字幕製作

Useful expressions / extensions:

photo caption

image caption

short caption

write a caption

caption a photo

closed captions

live captioning

auto-generated captions

captioned video

caption under a picture

legal caption **(specialist)**

Meaning in this passage

> It was a scrapbook filled with printed photos, short **captions**, little notes, and a few tickets and receipts...

Here, **captions** means:

short pieces of text placed next to or under photographs to explain or identify them — 圖片說明；照片下的簡短文字

The speaker added brief written descriptions to the photos in the scrapbook.

中文翻譯：

那是一本剪貼簿，裏面放了沖印照片、簡短的**圖片說明文字**、小紙條，以及一些票根和收據。

So here:

****caption = 配在照片旁邊或下面，用來說明人物、地點、時間或情境的簡短文字****

1. ****caption (圖片說明) — 圖片說明；圖說****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The scrapbook was filled with printed photos and short ****captions****.

剪貼簿裏有很多沖印照片和簡短的****圖片說明****。

Practice 2

> She wrote a funny ****caption**** under the family photo.

她在家庭照下面寫了一句有趣的****圖說****。

Practice 3

> The ****caption**** explains when and where the picture was taken.

這段****圖片說明****解釋了照片是在何時何地拍攝的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****caption = 放在圖片旁邊或下方，用來解釋、識別或補充圖片內容的文字****

2. ****photo caption — 照片說明****

Practice 1

> Each photo had a short ****caption****.

每張照片都有一段簡短的****照片說明****。

Practice 2

> The ****photo caption**** named everyone in the picture.

****照片說明****列出了照片中每個人的名字。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****photo caption = 專門配在照片旁邊、用來說明照片內容的文字****

3. ****image caption — 圖像說明****

Practice 1

> The website automatically added an ****image caption****.

網站自動加入了****圖片說明****。

Practice 2

> Every ****image caption**** should be clear and concise.

每段****圖片說明****都應清楚簡潔。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****image caption = 配在圖片或圖像旁邊的說明文字****

4. ****write a caption — 寫圖片說明****

Practice 1

> She ****wrote a caption**** for every photo.

她為每張照片都****寫了說明文字****。

Practice 2

> Can you ****write a caption**** for this picture?

你可以為這張圖片****寫一句圖說****嗎？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****write a caption = 為圖片寫一段簡短的解釋或說明文字****

5. ****caption a photo — 為照片加說明文字****

Here ****caption**** is a verb.

Practice 1

> He **captioned the photo** with the date and place.

他在照片上**加上日期和地點說明**。

Practice 2

> Each image was carefully **captioned**.

每張圖片都被仔細**加上說明文字**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****caption a photo/image = 為照片或圖片加上說明文字****

6. ****caption (字幕) — 字幕 ; 文字轉錄****

A major modern media sense.

Practice 1

> Turn on the **captions** if you can't hear clearly.

如果聽不清楚，可以開啟**字幕**。

Practice 2

> The video includes English **captions**.

這段影片附有英文**字幕**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****captions = 顯示在影片畫面上的文字，用來呈現對話、旁白或重要聲音資訊****

7. ****closed captions — 隱藏式字幕 ; 可開關字幕****

Practice 1

> The programme provides **closed captions**.

這個節目提供**可開關字幕**。

Practice 2

> I turned on the **closed captions**.

我開啟了**隱藏式字幕**。

MCQ-ready definition:

closed captions = 觀眾可以自行開啟或關閉的字幕，通常包括對話及重要聲音資訊

8. **captions vs subtitles — 字幕的不同功能**

This distinction is useful.

captions

often reproduce:

- * spoken dialogue
- * speaker labels
- * sound effects
- * music cues

subtitles

often focus mainly on:

- * spoken dialogue
- * translation into another language

Example:

> [door slams]

may appear in **captions** but not necessarily in ordinary subtitles.

MCQ-ready definition:

captions = 除對話外，常包括非語言聲音資訊的字幕

9. **live captioning — 即時字幕**

Practice 1

> The conference provided **live captioning**.

會議提供**即時字幕**。

Practice 2

> **Live captioning** helps people follow spoken presentations.

即時字幕幫助人們跟上口頭演講內容。

MCQ-ready definition:

live captioning = 在說話發生的同時即時產生並顯示字幕

10. **automatic / auto-generated captions** — 自動生成字幕

Practice 1

> The platform created **auto-generated captions**.

平台產生了**自動生成字幕**。

Practice 2

> Automatic **captions** may contain mistakes.

自動**字幕**可能會有錯誤。

MCQ-ready definition:

auto-generated captions = 由語音辨識系統自動產生的字幕

11. **captioned video** — 附字幕影片

Practice 1

> We watched a **captioned video**.

我們看了一段**附字幕的影片**。

Practice 2

> All training videos are **captioned**.

所有培訓影片都**附有字幕**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****captioned video = 已加入文字字幕的影片****

12. ****caption (法律文件標題欄) — 法律文件標題 / 案名欄****

A specialist but established sense.

Practice 1

> The case name appears in the ****caption**** of the document.

案件名稱列在文件的****標題欄****。

Practice 2

> Check the legal ****caption**** before filing the document.

提交文件前先檢查法律文件的****案名標題欄****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****legal caption = 法律文件上標示法院、案件名稱、當事人等資料的正式標題部分****

This is useful to know, but much less common than photo/video senses.

Important distinction 1: ****caption vs title****

****caption****

explains or identifies a picture, chart, or video content.

****title****

names a work, article, section, or piece.

> photo caption

照片說明

> article title

文章標題

A caption usually **explains**; a title usually **names**.

Important distinction 2: **caption vs label**

caption

usually a short descriptive sentence or phrase.

label

usually a short identifying word/name.

> caption: "Mum and me in Kyoto, 2023."

圖說

> label: "Kyoto"

標籤

Important distinction 3: **caption vs description**

description

can be long and detailed.

caption

usually short and directly attached to an image/video.

So a caption is a type of brief description, but not every description is a caption.

Important distinction 4: **caption vs note**

caption

specifically explains an image or media element.

note

broader:

- * reminder
- * personal message
- * extra information

In your scrapbook:

- * **caption** → explains a photo
- * **note** → personal written message

That distinction is especially relevant to the passage.

Important distinction 5: **caption vs comment**

caption

attached to an image/video.

comment

response or opinion about content.

A social-media photo may have:

- * one caption by the poster
- * many comments by viewers

Important distinction 6: **caption vs subtitle**

caption

often includes spoken and non-spoken audio information.

subtitle

usually focuses on dialogue and often translation.

However, everyday platforms sometimes use the terms loosely.

Important distinction 7: **caption vs transcript**

caption

appears synchronized with video/audio.

transcript

usually gives the complete spoken content as a separate text document.

So:

> captions = time-linked text on screen

> transcript = full written record

Important distinction 8: **caption as noun vs verb**

Noun

> a short **caption**

一段圖片說明

Verb

> **caption** the photo

為照片加說明

This is a straightforward POS shift.

Important distinction 9: **short caption vs full explanation**

A caption is normally concise.

So in your passage:

> **short captions**

suggests little snippets such as:

- * “Our first family trip to Macau”
- * “Mum laughing at dinner”
- * “Summer 2022”

rather than long paragraphs.

Family-extension note

****Caption**** has two major modern branches:

1. ****image/text explanation****

- * photo caption
- * image caption
- * caption a photo

2. ****video accessibility text****

- * captions
- * closed captions
- * live captioning
- * captioned video

These are semantically connected:

****brief text attached to visual content to explain or represent it****

There is also a narrower specialist branch:

3. ****legal caption****

- * formal heading/identification block on legal documents

For learners, the strongest contrast is:

****caption = 圖片說明****

vs

****captions = 影片字幕****

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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caption (image)	圖片說明；圖說	text explaining image
photo caption	照片說明	text under photo
image caption	圖像說明	text for image
write a caption	寫圖說	create explanation
caption a photo	為照片加說明	add text
caption (video)	字幕	on-screen text
closed captions	可開關字幕	accessibility captions
live captioning	即時字幕	real-time text
auto-generated captions	自動生成字幕	machine-generated text
captioned video	附字幕影片	video with captions
legal caption	法律文件標題欄	case heading
captioning	加字幕 / 字幕製作	caption process

For your original sentence

> It was a scrapbook filled with printed photos, short ****captions****, little notes, and a few tickets and receipts...

Here:

****captions = 照片旁邊或下面的簡短說明文字****

The key difference from the ****little notes**** that come immediately after it is:

* ****captions**** → explain the photo

* ****notes**** → personal messages, comments, memories, or thoughts

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 那是一本剪貼簿，裏面放了沖印照片、簡短的****圖片說明文字****、小紙條，以及一些票根和收據。

For this passage, ****「圖片說明 / 照片說明」**** is the cleanest sense.